MONTHLY UPDATE

Angola: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-05 · 36 systems and instruments tracked, 10 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-05 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

A four-day national mobile outage from 28 July dominated the month and tested an architecture that has decrees but no law. The incumbent's network went down at 02:20 and was restored gradually to 30 July; the state had settled the sale of 15% of that operator the day before. The kwanza entered the regional settlement system on 27 July.

Infrastructure

The incumbent operator's mobile voice, data and internet services failed nationwide from 02:20 on 28 July, affecting more than twenty million customers; fixed fibre and fixed-wireless stayed up throughout, so the failure was confined to the mobile layer. Restoration ran four days — localised from 11:45 on 29 July, full second- and third-generation national coverage at about 23:00 on 30 July, and messaging and electronic airtime sales back on 31 July. Four days in, card terminals were still unreliable in Luanda shops and filling stations. No attribution, access vector or scope of data loss is established.

The Executive's first answer to the National Assembly on critical-infrastructure risk, given on 31 July, was the standing build programme — the national data centre and the country-code domain — with no new measure, obligation or timetable announced. Telecommunications remains undesignated as critical national infrastructure, and named analysts argued during the month that it should be designated alongside power and water.

A regional preparatory meeting on radiocommunications opened in Luanda on 3 August, five days into the outage, with the resilience of telecommunications infrastructure on its agenda.

Digital public infrastructure

Two payment milestones fell within a fortnight. The central bank completed migration of domestic payments to the international messaging standard on 10 July across the switch, the exchange and the real-time settlement participants. And on 27 July the kwanza was formally introduced into the regional real-time settlement system — the second currency added since that system launched in 2013 — against 2025 trade and interbank flows with the other fourteen member states of about US$3.77bn across nine currencies.

Identity delivery moved in two directions. From 1 July all 21 provinces print the identity card locally, ending centralisation at a single production centre, with two to three printers per province planned and a 24-to-48-hour issuance target; one province reports issuance under 24 hours against one to two weeks before June. Against that, more than 120,000 issued cards were awaiting collection nationwide as at 15 July, prompting a civic campaign enlisting churches and traditional authorities. On 28 July the justice ministry launched an at-home service priced at Kz 250,000 for processing and Kz 10,000 for delivery alone, in one province only, the minister justifying the fee as a product of exclusivity.

The statistics office launched a census portal and a mobile application on 2 July, both built by its own technical staff, carrying census indicators by geographic level and macroeconomic series; no open-data licence, bulk download or programming interface is stated. A logistics regulator communiqué of 27 July described a single window absorbing three separate agency platforms, framed explicitly as a formalisation and tax-base instrument. A single social register was launched in the week ending 25 July with no enrolment target, data-protection basis or governing instrument stated.

Governance and regulation

The cybersecurity bill re-entered detailed consideration. Three specialised committees met jointly on 3 August and voted it chapter by chapter on three axes — drafting, systematisation and harmonisation — all presented as preserving the substance approved in generality in January 2026 on 105 votes for, one against and 75 abstentions. Deputies had suspended the same discussion on 7 and 8 July over drafting non-conformities in the preamble and first two chapters, one party warning that a redraft that deep might require a wholly new bill.

Five days before that vote, the country's own delegation told a regional forum in Lusaka on 29 July that its cybersecurity law was still in a diagnostic phase. Both statements are the government's own.

The National Assembly approved legislative authorisation 166 votes to nil on 30 July for the President to legislate an electronic-signature and digital-certification regime, valid 90 days after publication of the enabling law — so the regime defining an accrediting authority, a root certification entity and the evidential weight of a signature will be an executive instrument, grounded on the insufficiency of two 2011 texts.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

The month's technology events were financial and commercial rather than industrial. The state raised Kz 300.3bn selling 15% of the incumbent operator, reported as about US$329m, at 120.72% subscription with 16,571 of 17,549 orders filled and 11,264 new shareholders; settlement fell on 28 July, the day the same operator's network went down.

At a trade fair on 22 July the second operator launched the web version of a subscription artificial-intelligence assistant at Kz 300 a month, replacing a text-message version, pitched at student research; no usage figure or model provenance is published. The following day a state-owned telecoms arm commercially launched an enterprise fifth-generation service in Cabinda at about US$20m, with a stated ambition of every provincial capital by 2027 — the operator's own figures.

The country's permanent representative to the United Nations argued on 31 July that persistent digital disparity keeps developing states out of artificial-intelligence rule-setting, and backed three international governance processes. That is a stated position rather than an instrument.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

The digital acceleration project acquired published targets for the first time. At its third steering committee on 30 July it was stated to be contracted to reach ten million people by March 2030, lifting broadband users from a stated baseline of 14,743,807 to 19.7 million and getting 400 firms onto green digital products, on US$300m of financing whose terms are a market-rate loan rather than concessional finance.

Financial inclusion was scored at 51.7% for the first quarter of 2026 against a 65% target for 2027 on 9 July, with banking at about 32% or 5.7 million people and mobile and digital payments up about 56% year on year; the strategy document itself is not held.

Satellite-based inclusion produced two counts eight days apart on different bases: 20,000 students across six universities and more than 300 localities on 13 July, and 3,972 students at two Luanda schools connected by satellite and white-space on 14 July. The regulator had licensed a first private reseller of national satellite capacity on 2 July, following 37 firms entering the commercial process by April.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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